

Session 1 — The Woods Ambush (Annotated Transcript)

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An annotated transcript of solo, troupe-style tabletop play: the player runs all four player-characters; the AI runs the world, the NPCs, and the dice. Every game mechanic is resolved with a real random roll and shown as *action (target N) → rolled R = result*.

The four PCs - Gardwen — feral-raised elf druid, divine caster (Channel 85). Wolf companion, Ruhi. - Magda — aged barbarian berserker, Blessed by Hel, Barkskin-warded protector. - Randall — Purewater street thief, invisible-backstab artist (Stealth 72, Deceit 75). - Conall — arcane investigator of the Blue Star (illusions, Change Appearance), wounded sword-arm.

Where we begin: Two nights before the Lake Lady's Tourney. The party has seeded a rumor to lure Santo di Teufel — the Baron's cruel heir — into the woods to recover the demonologist's soul-knife he abandoned at the scene of his crime.

Opening the scene

Player: continue the purewater campaign. Can I play all the PCs at once?

GM: Yes — troupe-style. Declare actions for whichever characters are in the scene; I run the world and the dice. You needn't voice everyone every beat — a quick intent is plenty. Play each PC honest to what they individually know; it makes the reveals land.

[Scene set: a staked clearing north of the Lullwater. A pallet dressed to look like a sick girl, temple incense burning to sell an "exorcism." Emmeralda is safe elsewhere. Sinnit's crew provides muscle. The party must decide bait, positions, and how to handle Santo's bodyguard, the albino lieutenant Blau.]

Prep — spell loadout

Player: What spells does gardwen and the magic user have?

GM: [Lists Gardwen's divine spells — Cure Serious Wounds, Entangle, Hold Person, Barkskin, Detect Evil... — and Conall's arcane list — Illusion, Change Appearance, Invisibility, MindSpeech, Shocking Grasp...]

Player: Any other good combat prep spells?

GM: [Recommends a buff package: Barkskin on Magda, Coordination + Invisibility on Randall, Protection on Conall, Gardwen sweeping with Detect Evil, Entangle held for the spring. Notes that pre-cast buffs spend magic points that won't refresh mid-fight.]

Player: Gardwen will use barkskin on Magda at the start of combat. We'll use Conall's illusion to sell the deception and invisibility on Randall to give him the chance to backstab someone.

Player: Protection on Conall sounds like a great idea too.

GM — pre-ambush rolls:

Conall Invisibility on Randall	(Arcane Casting 73)	→ 22 ✓
Randall Stealth (into position)	(72)	→ 22 ✓
Gardwen Stealth	(50)	→ 05 ✓ CRITICAL
Conall Stealth	(50)	→ 27 ✓
Conall Illusion (false Emmeralda)	(73)	→ 81 x ... recast → 74 x (failed by 1)
Conall Protection (self)	(73)	→ 80 x
Magda Stealth	(68)	→ 89 x (poorly hidden)

Randall vanishes and slips into perfect stab position; Gardwen and Ruhi crit their hide. But the illusion won't take — two failed casts — and Conall's self-ward also fails. Magda is badly placed, her shield-rim catching the rushlight. And Sinnit's lookout whistles: torchlight incoming — Santo, two hired blades, and Blau trailing sixty paces back in the dark.

Player: Luck point for the illusion - switch 81 → 18

GM: Conall spends a Luck Point (→ 3). The 81 becomes 18 — success. The false, dying Emmeralda blooms over the pallet and holds. Santo reaches the rushlight ring, sees her, buys it — "...Emmeralda" — and steps in. The soul-knife is on his belt.

The ambush — round one

Player: Entangle the two thugs. Randall to silently kill / immobilize Santo. Magda to jump out and finish him off quickly if that doesn't work.

GM — round rolls:

Gardwen Channel (Entangle)	(85)	→ 63 ✓
Thug A resist Evade	(~30)	→ 91 x → rooted
Thug B resist Evade	(~30)	→ 19 ✓ → tears free
Gardwen Channel (Barkskin→Magda)	(85)	→ 41 ✓
Randall dagger vs unaware Santo	(~68)	→ 85 x
Magda charge attack (vs Thug B)	(~72)	→ 50 ✓

Entangle roots one thug; the other breaks loose. Barkskin hardens Magda's skin. But Randall's backstab fouls — Santo shifts toward the pallet and the blade only scores his cloak.

Player: Randall spends a luck point to get it to work

GM: Randall spends a Luck Point (→ 3). [GM ruling: honored as a convert-to-success, per the player's intent.] The invisible dagger drives home.

Dagger damage 1d4+1 → 5 | backstab bonus 1d4 → 2 (7 to the chest, unaware target)

Santo folds, incapacitated, a lung filling. The soul-knife rings against a root.

The kill and the switch

Player: Randall will finish him off, whispering "this is for emmerelda, brother." Randall can drop the illusion and set for Blau as will Gardwen. Magda will go full berserker on the thug.

GM:

Randall killing blow vs helpless Santo → automatic (no defense possible)

Dagger to the throat 1d4+1 → 5 → Santo di Teufel is DEAD

Magda berserk attack (style ~80, boon) → 69 / 02, take better = 02 ✓ CRITICAL

Hunting-axe damage 1d8+1 → 8

Thug B Evade (30) → 83 x | Endurance to stay up → 81 x → thug down

Randall opens the heir's throat — "This is for Emmeralda, brother." Magda gives herself to Hel's fury and cleaves the second thug down in one critical blow. Conall drops the illusion. Blau is one round out, coming hard, drawn by Santo's scream.

Reader's note — showing the rules

Player: Remember. Show the die rolls for all the game mechanics. That should be in the instructions.

GM: Saved as a standing instruction. From here on, every mechanic shows its roll as action (target N) → rolled R = result, including Luck spends. [Recaps the round in a table.]

Handling Blau — the body-switch con

Player: Let's set it up as a switch. Conall casts change appearance or mimic to make himself look like Santo. Then he'll grab the knife, wait for Blau to appear and then pretend to be Santo and scream, running away as if he's trying to escape "shouting assassins!"

GM — the con:

Conall Change Appearance	(Arcane Casting 73)	→ 20 ✓	(flawless disguise)
Conall Deceit as Santo (opposed)	(75)	→ 85 x	
Blau Insight (opposed)	(60)	→ 48 ✓	→ Blau wins, NOT fooled
Blau Perception (read the clearing)(72)		→ 21 ✓	→ sees Santo's corpse

The magic is perfect — Conall is Santo to the eye — but the performance fails: Blau's ear catches the wrong voice, his eye catches the real body. He howls a genuine alarm ("TO ME, DRAGON KNIGHTS!") and sprints after the disguised Conall — who runs at Athletics 49 while Blau runs at 70. A losing footrace... unless the trap closes.

Player: Gardwen hits Blau with Hold Person. Randall will lay chase as will Ruhi. How's Magda doing?

GM: [Magda: unharmed, Barkskin intact, but deep in berserk — she needs a Willpower check to choose her target rather than take the nearest throat.]

Gardwen Channel (Hold Person)	(85)	→ 74 ✓
Blau resist Willpower (opposed)	(60)	→ 30 ✓

Both succeed → opposed contest, higher successful roll wins: Gardwen's 74 beats Blau's 30. The Hold takes him. Mid-sprint, three strides from Conall, the lieutenant locks rigid as a fencepost. A Dragon Knight patrol's horn answers his call, closing.

The escape

Player: Run. Get the fuck of there. I thought if you attack someone in hold person and they come out of it immediately, if you just leave them it takes a bit longer. Run. Hide. survive

GM: Correct — striking a held target snaps them free instantly; leaving Blau untouched lets the Hold run its full duration. You run.

Magda Willpower (break berserk)	(63) → 20 ✓
Magda Stealth (flee)	(68) → 67 ✓ (by 1)
Conall Stealth (flee)	(50) → 20 ✓
Gardwen Stealth (flee)	(50) → 94 x
Randall Stealth (flee)	(72) → 99 x FUMBLE
Patrol Perception	(~55) → 16 ✓ (sharp-eyed)

Magda reins in her fury and runs. But Randall's exit is a disaster — a rotten log gives way, he crashes loud through brambles as the torches arrive, and a knight gets a clean look: a fleeing man who “looked just like Lord Santo.” You lose the pursuit in the canals, but you leave a wake: Blau lives, a witness survived, and the Dragon Knights now hunt a Santo-faced suspect — pointing straight at the twins.

Outcome: The heir is dead. The Asmodeus soul-knife is recovered. The plot is off its rails — and the Baron will learn of his son's murder by dawn.

Aftermath — reporting to patrons

Player: [Log the events.]

GM: [Five events written to *journal/events.json*; Santo marked dead; campaign clock advanced to Session 1, two days before the tourney.]

Player: Conall can just report as normal - try to see if there are any resources we can get to equip ourselves with. Randall will also report back to the madames for the pleasure isle that their revenge is complete. [Tell Temerach the heir is gone but we were seen.]

GM — the two reports:

Conall Influence (press Temerach for gear)	(62) → 55 ✓
Temerach's disposition	2d6 → 12 (warmest she gets)
Randall Influence (claim the reward)	(63) → 73 x
Randall Streetwise (read the room)	(66) → 75 x
Marisette's disposition	2d6 → 8 (guarded)

Temerach is grim but all-in: she takes the knife as evidence, arms the party (hooded cloaks, cuirass, daggers, coin), offers a Temple Isle safehouse, and a chirurgeon for Conall's arm. “You've turned a careful game into a knife-fight in the dark. So be it.”

Marisette is pleased the animal's dead but afraid of the heat a murdered heir brings. Randall, misreading the room, expects a hero's purse and instead gets a token payment and a cold warning: “Be a stranger. The houses never heard your name.”

The night's last moves

Player: Take up Temerach's offer. Pass the knife over. Have Randall visit the moist oyster to see what the rumor mongers are saying.

GM:

Conall's arm – Sword chirurgeon	(~65) → 86 x	(arm still out; magic only, 2 days)
Randall Streetwise (the Oyster)	(66) → 02 ✓	CRITICAL (a flood of rumor)
Randall Insight (sort truth from lies)	(62) → 80 x	(can't tell gold from dross)
Patron Perception (clock Randall)	(~45) → 13 ✓	(a watcher marks his face)
Thorne's disposition	2d6 → 8	(guarded)

The knife is secured as evidence under the Lake Lady's protection. Conall's arm won't heal in time — he goes into the tournament window as a caster only. Randall works the Oyster brilliantly and gathers a dozen rumors — true, false, and tavern-nonsense all tangled together, and tonight he can't tell which is which. Worse, a hard-faced watcher by the door keeps resting his eyes on Randall's face — the very face the city is whispering about — while Blau hunts the docks for it. Thorne tilts his head toward the back exit: warning, favor, or trap? Randall can't read him.

[Session pauses here — the party safe but marked, the knife secured, the Baron's grief and the tournament two days out.]

What this showcases

- One player, four characters. The player declares by intent ("Magda goes full berserker," "Randall lays chase"); the GM voices and resolves each PC and every NPC.
- Every mechanic is a visible, honest roll. Successes and failures both drive the story — the failed illusion, the fumbled escape, and the misread madame all became plot.
- Luck Points as narrative currency. The player spent Luck to force the illusion and the backstab at the two moments that mattered.
- Rules literacy is rewarded. The player's call to not attack the Held Blau (so the paralysis would last) was correct and shaped the escape.
- Consequences persist. Killing Santo diverged from the source material; the GM logged it to the campaign journal, advanced the clock, and seeded the fallout (the manhunt, the live witness, Conall's crippled arm) into the next scene.